

HRIS Onboarding Workflow

Portfolio Case Study (Simulated) — IT Access & Equipment Provisioning

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1. Project Overview

This case study focuses on improving an HRIS onboarding workflow to ensure new hires are fully “Day 1 ready.” The workflow includes HR creating the employee record, assigning required onboarding tasks, manager approvals, and IT provisioning (laptop, email, and system access). The goal is to accelerate onboarding and eliminate process gaps by implementing automated triggers, real-time status tracking, and clearly defined ownership across HR, IT, and management.

2. Problem Statement

The current HRIS onboarding process relies on manual handoffs between HR, hiring managers, and IT. As a result, IT provisioning (equipment and access) is frequently delayed or missed, and stakeholders lack visibility into onboarding status. This leads to new hires starting without the required tools and access to perform their job.

Business impact includes:

- Delayed Day 1 productivity due to missing accounts and equipment
- Increased HR/IT follow-ups and support tickets to resolve onboarding gaps
- Poor new hire experience and reduced confidence in the onboarding process

2.2 Assumptions & Risks

Assumptions

- The HRIS is the system of record for onboarding status and task assignments.
- Hiring managers and IT teams use standardized forms/tickets for provisioning requests.
- Required approval roles (manager/security) are defined and available within the workflow.

Risks

- Integration or ticketing delays may prevent timely creation or updates of IT provisioning work items.
- Incomplete or inaccurate equipment/access requests may still cause rework without strong validation and ownership.
- Approval bottlenecks (manager/security) may continue to delay Day 1 readiness during peak hiring periods.

2.1 Scope

In Scope

- Automated manager notification and standardized intake for equipment and access requirements
- Validation of required fields before request submission
- Automatic creation of IT provisioning tickets/work items
- Onboarding dashboard visibility (HR, manager, IT) and status tracking
- Approval tracking (manager/security as applicable) with reminders/escalations
- “Day 1 Ready” status and stakeholder notifications

Out of Scope

- Payroll, benefits enrollment, or compensation configuration
- Recruiting/ATS workflow redesign (pre-hire processes)
- Performance management, training programs, or long-term employee development
- Vendor selection or system migration activities beyond onboarding workflow design

3. Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Type	Goal	Current pain	Influence
New hire	External	Complete onboarding smoothly and be ready to work on Day 1	Delayed access/equipment due to missed or late handoffs	Medium
HR	Internal	Standardize onboarding tasks and ensure timely completion across teams	Manual coordination and follow-ups due to unclear ownership and limited status visibility	High
Hiring manager	Internal	Ensure the new hire is productive quickly with required tools and access	New hires start without access/equipment, delaying productivity	High
IT Service Desk	Internal	Provision accounts and equipment on time based on complete approved requests	Late or incomplete requests and last-minute escalations	Medium
Security	Internal	Ensure access is provisioned correctly with auditability and least privilege	Rushed access requests increase risk and reduce audit traceability	Medium
HRIS Admin	Internal	Configure and maintain onboarding workflows and task routing in the HRIS	Workflow rules and integrations require updates to reduce manual work	Medium

4. Current State Analysis

4.1 Current Process Flow

A candidate accepts the job offer and becomes a new hire. HR creates the new hire record in the HRIS and assigns onboarding tasks (forms and policy acknowledgements). HR then manually notifies the hiring manager (Slack/Teams) to initiate onboarding needs. The hiring manager manually submits equipment and access requirements, often through separate messages or

ticket requests. IT receives the request and provisions the laptop and required system access. Because task ownership and status are not centralized, HR and the hiring manager frequently follow up manually with IT for updates. As a result, new hires sometimes start on Day 1 without the necessary access or equipment, delaying productivity.

4.2 Current Issues Identified

- Manual handoffs between HR, hiring managers, and IT cause provisioning requests to be delayed or missed
- No centralized visibility into onboarding status, resulting in frequent follow- ups and escalations
- Approvals (manager/security) are delayed, slowing down access provisioning
- Requests are sometimes submitted with incomplete or inconsistent information, causing rework and further delays

4.3 Business Impact

- Delayed Day 1 productivity when new hires start without required accounts, access, or equipment
- Increased HR and IT workload due to manual coordination, follow- ups, and escalations
- Poor new hire experience, increasing early frustration and reducing confidence in the onboarding process

5. Future State Analysis

5.1 Future Process Summary

The HRIS onboarding workflow is redesigned to reduce manual handoffs and improve visibility. HR creates the new hire record and assigns required onboarding tasks. The hiring manager is automatically notified to submit equipment and access needs through a standardized request form. Once submitted and validated, the HRIS automatically creates an IT provisioning ticket/work item. IT completes provisioning, and the onboarding dashboard updates in real time. When required tasks and approvals are complete, the HRIS marks the new hire “Day 1 Ready” and notifies HR, the hiring manager, and the new hire.

5.2 Expected Outcomes

- Reduced missed handoffs and rework through standardized requests and automated workflow triggers
- Faster Day 1 readiness by starting provisioning earlier and tracking progress end- to- end
- Fewer follow- ups, escalations, and onboarding- related tickets due to improved visibility and clear ownership

6. Process Flow

6.1 Process Flow Diagram

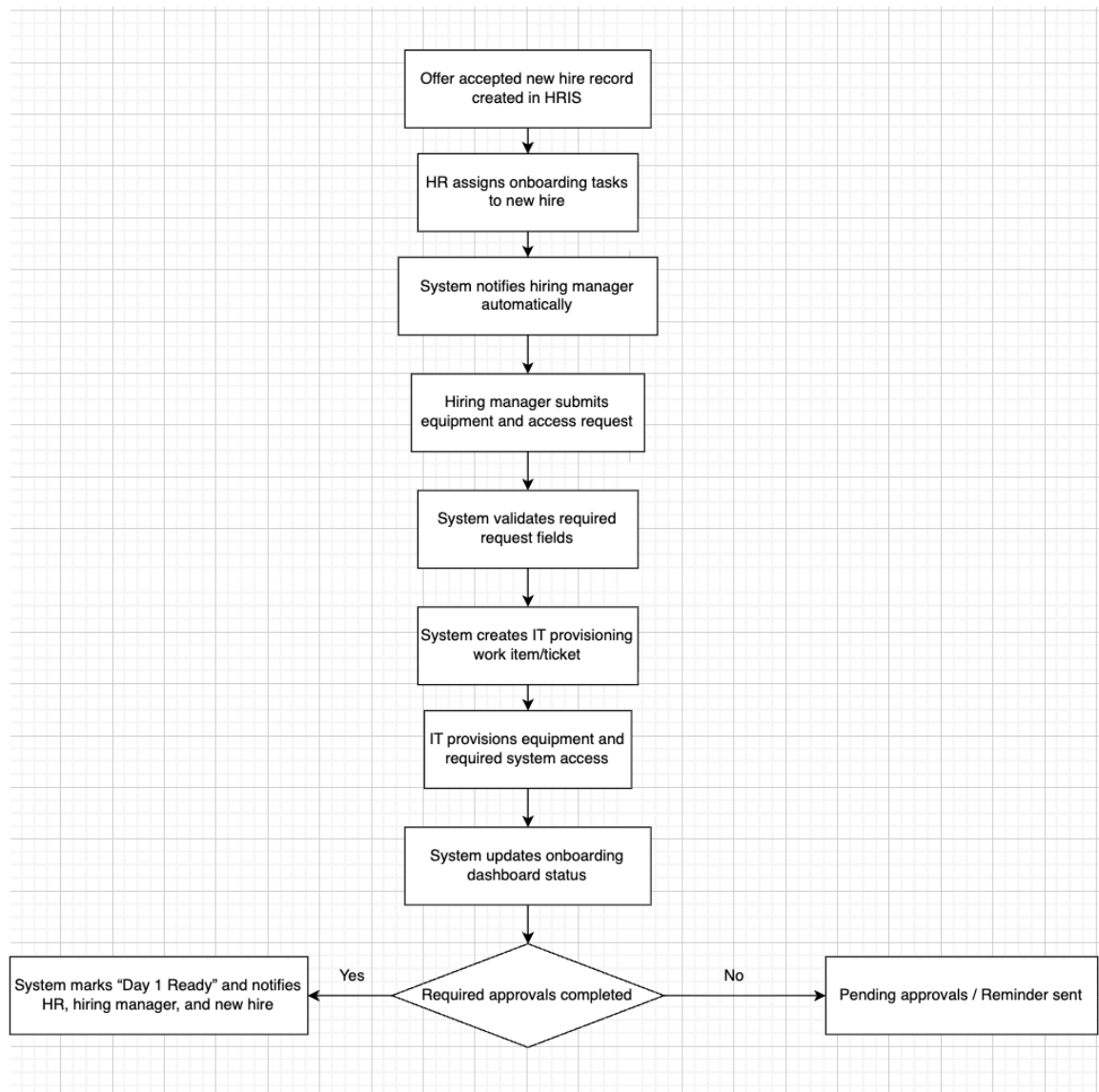


Figure 1. HRIS onboarding workflow (future state)

6.2 System Interaction Overview

The HRIS triggers onboarding activities when an offer is accepted and a new hire record is created. HR assigns onboarding tasks, while the system prompts the hiring manager to submit equipment and access requirements via a standardized form. Upon successful submission, the HRIS creates an IT provisioning ticket/work item and updates onboarding status on a dashboard. IT completes provisioning and updates ticket status, and the HRIS tracks approvals as applicable. Once all required tasks, approvals, and provisioning steps are complete, the HRIS marks the new hire as "Day 1 Ready" and notifies HR, the hiring manager, and the new hire.

6.3 Key Data Elements

New Hire & Onboarding Data

- New hire ID / employee ID
- Start date and role/department
- Hiring manager ID
- Onboarding task list and task completion status
- Overall onboarding status (In Progress, Blocked, Day 1 Ready)

Equipment & Access Request Data

- Equipment/access request ID
- Requested equipment and required applications/systems
- Required approvals and approval status (pending/approved/declined)
- IT provisioning ticket/work item ID
- Provisioning status and timestamps (created, in progress, completed)
- Decline/rework reason codes (if request is rejected or needs changes)

Audit & Notification Data

- Notification delivery status (sent/failed) for HR/manager/new hire
- Audit log entries for approvals and access provisioning actions

7. Requirements

7.1 Functional Requirements

ID	Functional requirement
FR-01	The system shall create a new hire record in the HRIS when an offer is accepted.
FR-02	The system shall assign required HR onboarding tasks to the new hire upon record creation.
FR-03	The system shall automatically notify the hiring manager to submit equipment and access requirements for the new hire.
FR-04	The system shall provide a standardized equipment and access request form for the hiring manager to complete.
FR-05	The system shall validate that all required request fields are completed before the request can be submitted.
FR-06	The system shall automatically create an IT provisioning work item/ticket when the request form is submitted successfully.
FR-07	The system shall track and display onboarding task status (HR tasks, manager request, IT provisioning, approvals) on an onboarding dashboard.
FR-08	The system shall route required approvals (manager/security) and record approval status within the onboarding workflow.
FR-09	The system shall send automated reminders/escalations for pending approvals or overdue IT provisioning tasks based on defined thresholds.
FR-10	The system shall mark the new hire as “Day 1 Ready” and notify HR, the hiring manager, and the new hire when all required tasks and approvals are complete.

7.2 Non-Functional Requirements

ID	Non-functional requirement
NFR-01	The system shall update onboarding dashboard status and send stakeholder notifications within 10 seconds of IT provisioning completion under normal operating conditions.
NFR-02	The system shall support at least 10,000 active onboarding workflows without performance degradation.
NFR-03	The system shall maintain 99% uptime during business hours to support onboarding operations.
NFR-04	The system shall enforce role-based access control so that access provisioning requests and approvals can only be submitted and approved by authorized roles (HR, hiring manager, IT, security).
NFR-05	The system shall log and retain an audit trail of onboarding requests, approvals, access provisioning actions, and status changes for compliance and reporting.

8. Acceptance Criteria

AC-01 — Manager Notification

- Given a new hire record has been created and onboarding tasks are assigned
- When the new hire completes the required onboarding forms
- Then the system notifies the hiring manager that the onboarding forms are complete

AC-02 — Form Validation

- Given the hiring manager is submitting the equipment and access request form
- When one or more required fields are missing
- Then the system prevents submission and displays an error message identifying the missing required fields

AC-03 — IT Ticket Creation

- Given the hiring manager submits a completed equipment and access request form
- When the form submission is validated successfully
- Then the system creates an IT provisioning work item/ticket and updates the onboarding dashboard status accordingly

AC-04 — Day 1 Ready Status

- Given IT provisioning tasks are completed and required approvals are completed
- When the onboarding workflow reaches completion
- Then the system updates the new hire status to “Day 1 Ready” and notifies HR, the hiring manager, and the new hire

9. User Stories

ID	User story
US-01	As a new hire, I want onboarding tasks and required access to be completed before my start date, so that I am ready to work on Day 1.
US-02	As an HR team member, I want onboarding tasks to be assigned automatically when a new hire record is created, so that onboarding is consistent and does not rely on manual coordination.
US-03	As a hiring manager, I want to submit equipment and access needs through a standardized request form, so that IT receives complete information without manual back-and-forth.
US-04	As an IT team member, I want onboarding provisioning requests to be created automatically as tickets, so that I can provision the correct equipment and access on time.
US-05	As HR or a hiring manager, I want to track onboarding status in a single dashboard, so that I can quickly identify blockers and follow up before Day 1.

10. Business Rules

ID	Business rule
BR-01	The system shall allow submission of an equipment/access request only when all required form fields are completed and validated.
BR-02	The system shall not provision system access for a new hire until all required approvals (hiring manager/security as applicable) are completed.
BR-03	The system shall not update the onboarding status to “Day 1 Ready” until all required provisioning tasks (equipment and system access) are marked complete.

11. Requirement Traceability

Problem identified	Requirement ID	Traceability mapping
Manual handoffs delay or miss IT provisioning requests	FR-03	Manager notified to submit equipment/access requirements
Inconsistent intake of equipment/access needs causes incomplete requests and rework	FR-04	Standardized equipment/access request form
Incomplete request submissions create rework and provisioning delays	FR-05	Required fields validated before submission
IT provisioning work starts late because requests are not created consistently	FR-06	IT provisioning ticket/work item auto-created
Lack of visibility causes frequent follow-ups and escalations	FR-07	Dashboard tracks and displays onboarding status
Approval delays block access provisioning and delay Day 1 readiness	FR-08	Approvals routed and recorded in workflow

Delayed tasks persist due to lack of automated follow-up	FR-09	Reminders/escalations sent for pending items
New hires begin Day 1 without access/equipment due to incomplete workflow completion	FR-10	"Day 1 Ready" status set and notifications sent

12. Success Metrics

- Percentage of new hires marked “Day 1 Ready” before their start date
- Average time from offer acceptance to IT provisioning ticket/work item creation
- Average time from provisioning ticket creation to completion of access and equipment setup
- Reduction in onboarding-related follow-ups/escalations between HR, managers, and IT
- Number of Day 1 access/equipment incidents reported per onboarding cohort